

THOMAS GEBERT

Software Engineer

Brooklyn, New York, United States

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SUMMARY

Engineer with 15 years driving technical strategy across distributed systems and data infrastructure at companies including Apple, Walmart, and Schrödinger. Architect platform-level changes that deliver measurable business outcomes, including a backend rewrite that cut cloud storage costs by ~80%. Frequent international conference speaker (Lambda Days, Clojure/conj) on formal methods and distributed systems, with deep experience mentoring engineers and shaping cross-team architecture.

SKILLS, LANGUAGES

- **Languages:** Java, Python, SQL, Clojure, C++, F#, Go, JavaScript, Scala, Erlang/OTP
- **Platforms & Frameworks:** .NET Framework, Vert.x, Node.js, Docker, ZeroMQ, core.async
- **Data & Streaming:** Kafka, Apache Spark, PostgreSQL, RocksDB, Cassandra, BigQuery
- **Cloud & Systems:** GCP, AWS, Linux, Shell Scripting
- **Media & Tools:** FFmpeg, GStreamer, libavcodec
- **Infrastructure & Practices:** Kubernetes, CI/CD, Argo, Terraform, Observability, System Design, Microservices

EDUCATION

Western Governors University
B.S. Computer Science

Salt Lake City, UT

Western Governors University
M.S. Computer Science

Salt Lake City, UT

University of York
Graduate Studies in Computer Science

York, United Kingdom

- Research in Formal Methods and Robotics (Isabelle, Haskell, FDR4).
- Verification tools for concurrency-safety in robotic systems.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Freed Inc.
Staff Software Engineer

New York, NY
Aug 2025 – Present

- Set technical direction for the data platform, architecting and leading the rebuild of the data pipeline on FiveTran, DBT, and Census with BigQuery, Hubspot, and Intercom.
- Drove the design and implementation of an encrypted data export system for clinician transcripts and notes, establishing security patterns adopted across the platform.
- Led the migration of core services to Kubernetes on GCP using Argo.

Schrödinger

New York, NY

Senior Software Engineer

Feb 2024 – Apr 2025

- Shaped the technical strategy for streaming storage architecture, driving augmentation of RocksDB and optimization of write throughput across streaming applications.
- Architected and led the replacement of RocksDB with a custom PostgreSQL backend (50% of prior throughput) while cutting cloud storage costs by 80% and reducing duplication across nodes.
- Championed the adoption of Vert.x, Caffeine caches, Bloom filters, and LMAX Disruptor to minimize latency across the platform.
- Guided deployment and operational practices for distributed apps on Google Cloud Platform.
- Owned the topology and evolution of Kafka Streams applications.

CUNY City Tech

New York, NY

Adjunct Lecturer (Contract)

Aug 2022 – Jun 2023

- Taught introductory and advanced programming (Python 3 and Java 17).
- Built interactive assignments and automated grading modules.
- Collaborated on robotics and cyber-physical systems curriculum.
- Received perfect student reviews for two consecutive semesters.

Reddit, Inc.

New York, NY

Senior Software Engineer

Aug 2022 – Nov 2022

- Redesigned image-resizing pipeline in Python and Go, reducing infra cost by approximately 40%.

Walmart Global Tech

New York, NY

Staff Software Engineer

Aug 2021 – Aug 2022

- Mentored engineers in distributed computing and functional programming.
- Designed multi-cluster chatbot architecture (F#, C#) with >30% latency reduction.
- Led GraphQL API design and multi-cluster deployment on Azure.

Thrive Global

New York, NY

Contract Engineer

Mar 2021 – Aug 2021

- Built localization features in Node.js and containerized services with Docker.

Apple, Inc.

New York, NY

Senior Software Engineer

Sep 2018 – Feb 2021

- Built telemetry & analytics (Java, Clojure, Kafka, Spark, Tableau).
- Created Kafka buffering for iTunes indexing/caching.
- Maintained rule engine (Objective-C/C++).

Walmart Global Tech (Jet.com)

Hoboken, NJ

Senior Software Engineer

Jul 2016 – Aug 2018

- Built microservices in F# on Azure using Kafka and Spark ML.
- Rebuilt transactional email system to Jet.com scale.

Earlier Roles

New York, NY / Dallas, TX / Orlando, FL

Software Engineer, Research Scientist, Application Developer, Web Developer

May 2011 – Jun 2016

- Held engineering roles at Tone Mobile, NYU, Sq1, Senico, Propulsion Labs, Amerinational Management Services, and Lockheed Martin.
- Developed web applications, internal tooling, and research software across startup and enterprise environments.

PUBLIC SPEAKING

Lambda Days 2025 — From ‘Java Sucks’ to ‘Java...Eh, Not Bad’

Lambda Days 2023 — Why Design Your Own Levels When Your Computer Can Do It?

Lambda Days 2022 — Predicting and Preventing Chaos with Formal Methods in TLA+

Lambda Days 2020 — Distributed Hash Tables, Video, and Fun!

Clojure/conj 2019 — Distributed Hash Tables, Video, and Fun!